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Dubai court orders NMC founder to pay \$46m

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

A Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC) court has ordered B.R. Shetty, founder of the collapsed NMC Healthcare empire, to pay \$46 million to State Bank of India (SBI) after finding he repeatedly lied under oath about signing a personal guarantee for a \$50 million loan.

Justice Andrew Moran delivered the judgment on October 8, describing Shetty's testimony as "an incredible parade of lies" and finding his evidence "incoherent and nonsensical" during the September 29 trial.

The case centred on whether Shetty signed a personal guarantee in December 2018 for a \$50 million loan given to NMC Healthcare. Shetty claimed throughout the proceedings that the signature was forged and that he had never met the bank's CEO, who witnessed the signing.

"I am bound to find that there is overwhelming witness and documentary evidence before me, which satisfies me that Mr Shetty has come before this Court and lied on oath in his multiple denials that he signed the Personal Guarantee," Justice Moran wrote in his judgment.

The judgment awards SBI \$45,997,554.59, including interest to the judgment date, with additional interest accruing at 9 per cent per annum until payment.

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Trump: I'll decide on one state or two for Middle East peace

US PRESIDENT HAILS GAZA TRUCE EVEN AS NEW VIOLENCE TESTS CALM

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

A day after hailing a "historic dawn" in the Middle East, US President Donald Trump said he will decide "what's right" for the region's future — including whether peace means one state or two — as a US-brokered Gaza truce held for the fifth day yesterday.

Trump's comments came after his whirlwind visit to Egypt's Sharm Al Shaikh on Monday, where he joined regional leaders in signing a declaration that ended two years of war between Israel and Hamas. The agreement, described by Trump as "the most significant peace breakthrough in decades," secured a ceasefire, the release of remaining Israeli hostages, and the opening of humanitarian corridors into Gaza.

"A lot of people like the one-state solution, some like the two-state solution," Trump told reporters aboard Air Force One on his return to Washington. "We'll have to see. I will decide what I think is right, but I'll be in coordination with other states and other countries."

Violence tests ceasefire

Even as Trump praised the deal, violence flared in Gaza City and Khan Younis yesterday.

Gaza's civil defence agency, run by Hamas, said six Palestinians were killed in two incidents when Israeli forces opened fire on civilians inspecting their homes.



AFP

■ A child sits on top of a vehicle loaded with belongings as displaced Palestinians return to their homes in the north of the Nuseirat refugee camp in the central Gaza Strip yesterday.

"Israeli quadcopter drones opened fire on civilians in Shujaia," said Mahmud Bassal, the agency's spokesman.

The Israeli military said troops fired after "several suspects were identified crossing the yellow line and approaching IDF positions in northern Gaza."

"Attempts were made to distance the suspects," the army said. "They did not comply and continued approaching the troops, who opened fire to remove the threat."

In a separate incident in Al Fukhari, southeast of Khan Younis, one person was killed in what Gaza officials described as a drone strike on a group of ci-

vilians. The Israeli army said the group had posed "an immediate threat" to troops near a dismantled Hamas weapons site.

Media restrictions in Gaza have made independent verification of the casualties difficult.

UN slams Israeli actions

The UN Special Rapporteur on the occupied Palestinian territory, Francesca Albanese, condemned the renewed killings, saying Israel's actions made a mockery of the ceasefire.

"Again: Ceasefire according to Israel = 'you cease, I fire,'" she wrote on X. "Calling it 'peace' is both an insult and a distraction."

Path ahead

The 20-point Sharm Al Shaikh declaration calls for a "credible pathway to Palestinian self-determination and statehood," and pledges US-led talks to define a political horizon for peaceful coexistence.

Trump said reconstruction and reform must come first.

"When Gaza redevelopment advances and reform takes hold, the conditions will finally be right for lasting peace," he said.

For now, though, as guns fall silent in Gaza, new flashes of violence are already testing whether the dawn Trump proclaimed can truly see the day.

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Dubai's new electric taxis let you speak to drivers in any language

AI translation and real-time monitoring make Dubai's taxis smarter

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Passengers hailing Dubai's new electric taxis may soon find the cars speaking their language. Dubai Taxi Company has rolled out a 100 per cent electric fleet equipped with built-in artificial-intelligence translation, allowing riders and drivers to communicate in real time regardless of nationality.

The feature forms part of a wider redesign of the city's taxi experience, developed in partnership with Kia. The new PV5 vehicles were co-designed with Dubai Taxi engineers, who supplied detailed input on seating, luggage space and accessibility from as early as 2021.

"The customer can speak in any language.



This is an AI feature that can be added here, where the device detects the voice and translates it for the driver," said Hisham Airan, Director of Operations at Dubai Taxi Company.

Airan explained that the translation tool is integrated directly into the taxi's smart meter and infotainment system, which now consolidates all trip information, fare visibility and digital payments. The same interface connects wirelessly to ride-hailing platforms such as Bolt, removing the need for multiple devices inside the cab. The meter also feeds live data to Dubai Taxi's operation and control centre, where four onboard cameras monitor driving behaviour, passenger safety and fatigue.

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